



like training a new Ability or searching for the answer to a relatively straightforward question. The long term goal is a big target that will take most of a story, if not the chronicle, to achieve, such as crafting a legendary Treasure or bringing down an entrenched Shadow Court mastermind.

When a goal is met, simply replace it with another. Doing so ensures that a character always has something to do or seek out, and isn't always waiting for the action of the story to come to her. Not to mention that goals provide angles on why she cares about current events, or what she feels she might gain from participating in dangerous quests or epic journeys.

Identity

Changelings are by nature beings of two worlds, and most must find a way to balance the reality of living in the mortal world with the demands of existing as a changeling in the enchanted one. While some characters abandon the Autumn world and give up any pretense of a mortal life, doing so can easily lead to the terrible condition known as Bedlam, and so most fae try to find some way to satisfy both parts of themselves. Striking a true balance is difficult, but such conflict lies at the heart of **Changeling**, and the reward for doing so can be a character truly at peace with herself and her seemingly contradictory nature.

Mortal Identity

Establishing your character's mortal history and identity is a crucial part of understanding how he sees himself fitting in to a world that isn't quite his anymore. Even if he's known about his changeling nature from a young age, unless he fled immediately into the depths of the Dreaming he still had to uphold at least some pretense of a "normal" life. Where did he grow up? What's his family life like? Did he drift away when he realized he wasn't really part of it, or cling even harder because of it? How did he do in school? What mortal friends did he have, and does he still keep in touch with them? Did he ever enchant anyone he knew, or otherwise try to let them in on her secret? Did he ever use his powers to try to help a mortal? What about using them to get even with a bully or a rival? How did that go?

Of course, a character's current mortal life and identity is also worth examining — after all, one main theme of **Changeling** is that even valiant knights and cunning sorcerers still need to buy groceries and pay rent. Does your character have a job? If so, what is it, and how does she feel about it? If not, how does she make ends meet? Where does she live? Does she have any mundane hobbies or interests she indulges? Does she have a social life with her mortal friends and coworkers? What about a lover? Children? How does she explain things like sudden absences, broken promises, or missed occasions due to events in her changeling life? Is there anything in her mortal life she'd prioritize over her changeling one? If so, what is it, and why? What do her mortal friends and relatives honestly think of her? Does she care?

Changeling Identity

While understanding your character's mortal identity is important for having a grasp on who he is and how he relates to that part of his life, most stories will naturally focus on his